

The Francophone sub-system of secondary education in Cameroon is administered by the Ministry of Secondary Education (**MINESEC**). It spans **7 years**, divided into two distinct cycles:

- **1st Cycle (Cycle d'Observation et d'Orientation):** 4 years (*6ème, 5ème, 4ème, 3ème*) culminating in the **BEPC** (*Brevet d'Études du Premier Cycle*) or **CAP** (*Certificat d'Aptitude Professionnelle*).
- **2nd Cycle (Cycle de Spécialisation):** 3 years (*Seconde, Première, Terminale*) leading to the national secondary school diploma. Progression requires passing the **Probatoire** at the end of *Première* before writing the final **Baccalauréat** in *Terminale*.

1. Enseignement Secondaire Général (ESG)

General secondary education is split into academic streams focused either on natural/applied sciences or humanities/social studies.

A. Enseignement Scientifique (Science Stream)

Focused on mathematics, physical sciences, chemistry, earth sciences, and technological innovation.

- **Série C (Mathématiques & Sciences Physiques):** Advanced mathematics and physics. Prepares students for engineering, physics, mathematics, and technological fields.
- **Série D (Sciences de la Vie et de la Terre - SVT):** Focuses heavily on biology, geology, chemistry, and mathematics. Standard pathway for medicine, pharmacy, agronomy, and environmental sciences.
- **Série E (Mathématiques & Technique):** Combines advanced pure mathematics with industrial technology/mechanics. Prepares students for polytechnic institutes and specialized engineering tracks.
- **Série TI (Technologies de l'Information):** Specialized in computer science, programming, networking, and information systems alongside standard scientific courses.

B. Enseignement Littéraire (Humanities & Arts Stream)

Focuses on languages, literature, philosophy, history, geography, and social sciences.

- **Série A1:** Focuses on Literature, Ancient Languages (Latin/Greek), and Modern Foreign Languages.
- **Série A2:** Focuses on Literature, Ancient Languages, and two Modern Foreign Languages (LV1, LV2).
- **Série A3:** Focuses on Literature and Latin.
- **Série A4:** The most common humanities stream; emphasizes Literature, Modern Languages (LV1, LV2), and Philosophy (introduced heavily in *Première* and *Terminale*).
- **Série A5:** Emphasizes multi-language fluency across three Modern Foreign Languages (LV1, LV2, LV3).
- **Série AC (Art Cinématographique):** Specialized stream focusing on film studies, audiovisual arts, and creative media.

2. Enseignement Secondaire Technique et Professionnel (ESTP)

Technical and vocational education is hands-on and career-oriented, combining general academic courses with applied practical workshop hours and internships.

A. Section Technique Industrielle (ST-IND)

Covers industrial design, engineering, mechanics, civil works, electronics, and applied sciences.

Series / Specialty Code	Field of Specialization
F1	Construction Mécanique (Mechanical Engineering)
F2	Électronique (Electronics)

Series / Specialty Code	Field of Specialization
F3	Électrotechnique (Electrical Engineering)
F4 (BA, BE, TP)	Génie Civil (Building, Architectural Design, Public Works)
F5	Froid et Climatisation (Refrigeration & HVAC)
F6 / CI	Génie Chimique & Chimie Industrielle (Industrial Chemistry)
F7 / F8	Sciences Biological & Health/Social Care Technologies
IB / MEB	Industrie du Bois / Menuiserie-Ébénisterie (Woodworking & Carpentry)
MAV / MISE	Maintenance Audiovisuelle / System Electronics Installation

B. Section Tertiaire et Commerciale (STT - Sciences et Technologies du Tertiaire)

Covers business administration, finance, accounting, sales, logistics, and service sector professions.

Specialty Code	Field of Specialization
CG	Comptabilité et Gestion (Accounting & Management)
ACC	Action et Communication Commerciale (Marketing & Sales)
ACA	Action et Communication Administrative (Office Administration / Secretarial)
FIG	Fiscalité et Informatique de Gestion (Taxation & Business IT)
SES	Sciences Économiques et Sociales (Economics & Social Sciences)
HOT / HO	Hôtellerie et Restauration (Hotel Management & Catering)

Specialty Code	Field of Specialization
TO / AAT	Tourisme et Agence de Voyage (Tourism & Travel Management)

3. Academic Structure & National Examination Map

Cycle 1 (4 Years: 6ème to 3ème)

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└— ESG Track —► BEPC Exam (End of 3ème)

└— ESTP Track —► CAP Exam (End of 3ème)

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Cycle 2 (3 Years: Seconde, Première, Terminale)

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└— Première Year —► Examen du PROBATOIRE (National Filter Exam)

└— Terminale Year —► Examen du BACCALAURÉAT (University & Higher Education Entrance)

- **Official Managing Bodies:**

- **OBC (Office du Baccalauréat du Cameroun):** Organizes and administers the Probatoire and Baccalauréat exams across all general and technical streams.
- **DECC (Direction des Examens, des Concours et de la Certification):** Overseas 1st cycle exams like the BEPC and CAP.